

Chapter 10

Stick to It Millionaires Are Consistent

“We are what we repeatedly do. Excellence, then, is not an act, but a habit.”

That sounds like one of those down-home, old-school pieces of advice we’ve heard from many of the millionaires in our study, but it’s not. That sentiment is a little older—*way older*. Author Will Durant summed up fourth-century wisdom from the great philosopher Aristotle in that one line, explaining that the secret to excellence is simply doing the same things over and over again. We have a word for that today: *consistency*. Consistency is the key that brings all these millionaire attributes together. You can take responsibility, you can be intentional, you can set goals, and you can work hard. But, if you don’t do these things *repeatedly*—year after year, decade after decade—then you’ll never get the results you want. Your millionaire goals won’t crash and burn; they’ll just fizzle and sputter out. It’s like taking your foot off the gas while you’re driving down the highway—your car won’t blow up, but it will gradually coast to a complete stop. All the progress you’ve made up to that point won’t matter, because you’ll be sitting on the side of the road. You would have lost all your momentum, and once that happens, you may never get it back.